CONNEXUS

black sea tech forum

5 - 7 Октомври 2026

Варна



Под патронажа на президента на
Република България г-жа Илияна Йотова

ЧЕРНОМОРСКИ ТЕХНОЛОГИЧЕН ФОРУМ

Технологии от 7-мо поколение без граници

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Business at the Center

Cyber Prevention, Human Behavior, and Resilience in the Digital Storm



Senior Commissioner Prof. Dr. Ilin Savov, D.Sc.

Rector of the Academy of the Ministry of Interior

When the sea gets rough, resilience becomes strategy.

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The Digital Storm: Threat Landscape 2026

The attack surface is expanding faster than most businesses adapt

31%
of breaches now start with software vulnerabilities

48%
of breaches now involve ransomware

AI-augmented attacks

AI helps attackers write better lures, scale reconnaissance and accelerate malicious code

Dependencies spread impact

Cloud, mobile, APIs and suppliers can turn one weak link into business disruption

Cyber risk is now operational, financial, legal and reputational risk

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Human Behavior: The Decisive Factor

Technology builds defenses. People decide whether they hold.

Why attacks work

Urgency, trust and routine.
Fatigue and alert overload.
Mobile-first phishing and scam calls.
Context-rich executive targeting

What employees need

Pause, verify and report.
MFA and password managers.
Clear rules for AI and data sharing.
A simple suspicious-event channel

What leaders must do

Build a no-blame reporting culture.
Reduce risky workarounds.
Train with realistic scenarios.
Reward early reporting, not silence

Cybersecurity is not only a technology issue. It is a behavior issue

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Why Business Is at the Center

A cyber incident is not only an IT event. It is a business event

Continuity

Downtime disrupts revenue, operations, logistics, payments and service delivery

Trust

Customers, partners and investors judge response speed, transparency and honesty

Compliance

NIS2, DORA, GDPR and contracts increase management responsibility and evidence requirements

Reputation

One incident can become a public crisis before the technical facts are complete

Cyber resilience protects business value, not just IT systems

Practical Defenses That Work

Simple controls, executed consistently, beat complex controls no one follows

1 **Know crown jewels**
Map critical data, systems, processes and dependencies

2 **Secure identities**
Use MFA, least privilege, admin separation and password managers

3 **Patch exposed systems**
Prioritize internet-facing assets, VPNs, cloud portals and exploited vulnerabilities

4 **Back up for reality**
Keep tested offline or immutable backups and clean restore procedures

5 **Train continuously**
Use short scenarios on phishing, mobile scams, AI fraud and reporting

6 **Control third parties**
Vet suppliers, cloud services, APIs and AI tools before they touch data

Protection starts with discipline and ends with consistency

From Protection to Resilience

GOVERN	ownership, board oversight, risk appetite
IDENTIFY	critical assets, data, processes, third parties
PROTECT	MFA, awareness, segmentation, secure configuration
DETECT	logging, monitoring, anomaly detection
RESPOND	roles, communications, containment, evidence
RECOVER	clean restoration, backups, lessons learned

Thank You

Questions & Discussion

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